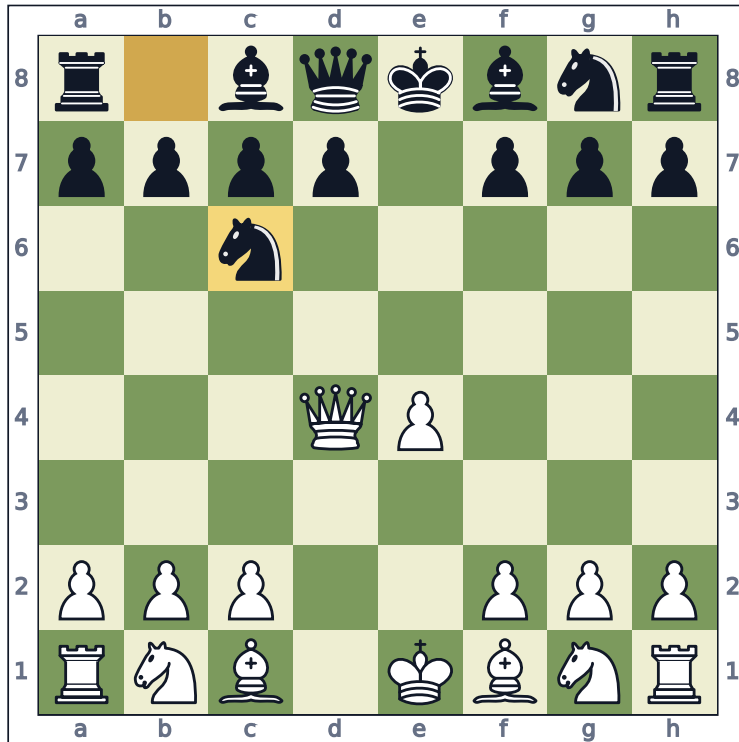


OPEN GAMES AFTER 1.E4 E5

Center Game

ECO C22 | 7 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.11 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C22 covers Center Game. Both sides contest the center directly, so development, king safety, and tactical accuracy become visible very early. The diagram uses the featured line Center Game: Normal Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nc6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop with threats, prepare d4 under favorable conditions, castle, and use any lead in development before it disappears.

BLACK'S GOALS

Neutralize pressure on e5, complete development, and use ...d5 when it solves the center in one move.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White's d4 and Black's ...d5 are the central freeing breaks. The f7 and f2 squares demand tactical attention.

PIECE MAP

Knights normally reach f3/c3 and f6/c6 quickly; bishops choose active diagonals according to the central tension. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Pawn grabbing and early queen moves are especially dangerous when the center can open with tempo. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on e4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Among the best openings for learning classical chess because strategic principles and tactics reinforce each other.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C22 line

This section preserves all 7 names and defining routes assigned to C22 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 **Center Game: Berger Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nc6 4. Qe3 Nf6

002 **Center Game: Charousek Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nc6 4. Qe3 Bb4+ 5. c3 Be7

003 **Center Game: Hall Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nc6 4. Qc4

004 **Center Game: Kupreichik Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nc6 4. Qe3 Nf6 5. Nc3 Bb4 6. Bd2 O-O 7. O-O-O Re8 8. Bc4 d6 9. Nh3

005 **Center Game: Normal Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nc6

006 **Center Game: Paulsen Attack Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nc6 4. Qe3

007 **Center Game: l'Hermet Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nc6 4. Qe3 f5